FREE COMPLETE LESSON

What Fuels You?

A speaking and vocabulary lesson for adult learners, A2–B1

Nine sections. Enough for one long lesson, or two comfortable ones.

SECTION 1 Warm-up discussion — five questions and the fuel metaphor

SECTION 2 Twelve functional phrases: runs on, is driven by, depends on…

SECTION 3 Vocabulary in four groups, with a blank column for translation

SECTION 4 Fifteen-sentence gap-fill, answer key printed in

SECTION 5 Sentence expansion, with a model answer

SECTION 6 Role-play preparation for a 1–1.5 minute monologue

SECTION 7 Twenty persona cards — profession, motivator, arguments

SECTION 8 Mini debate: ten questions and useful language

SECTION 9 Personal reflection and pair discussion

Print it or share your screen. Works 1-to-1 and in small groups.

Free to use in your own teaching. Please don't resell it or share it as your own.

WHAT FUELS YOU?

Level	A2 B1
Activity	

SECTION 1: WARM-UP DISCUSSIONDiscussion Questions

1. Is coffee only fuel for you, or do you actually enjoy it?
2. What helps you wake up in the morning?
3. What gives you energy during the day?
4. What motivates you when you don't feel like working?
5. What would happen if you had no fuel?

Introduction

Everything runs on some kind of fuel.

Fuel can be literal or metaphorical.

Examples:

- Cars **run on** petrol.
  - Phones **run on** electricity.
  - Students run on coffee.
  - Athletes run on discipline.
  - Parents run on love and responsibility.
  - Entrepreneurs run on innovation.
  - Scientists run on curiosity.

Discussion:

What fuel do you think each of these people needs?

- Teacher
  - Doctor
  - Musician
  - Student
  - Professional athlete
  - Parent
  - Business owner

SECTION 2: FUNCTIONAL LANGUAGEUseful Phrases

Phrase	Meaning	Example
It works on...	Uses something to function	My laptop works on electricity.
It runs on...	Gets energy from something	My car runs on petrol.
It looks like...	Similar appearance	It looks like a small computer.
It sounds like...	Similar sound	It sounds like a helicopter.
It is powered by...	Receives power from	The factory is powered by solar energy.
It is driven by...	Motivated by	She is driven by ambition.

Quick Practice

Complete the sentences:

1. A smartphone runs on _____.
2. A student is driven by _____.
3. A plant requires _____.
4. Success depends on _____.
5. A teacher needs _____.

Phrase	Meaning	Example
It needs...	Necessary to function	A plant needs water.
It requires...	Must have	Success requires patience.
It depends on...	Relies on	The project depends on teamwork.
It is made for...	Purpose	This app is made for language learners.
It works with...	Cooperates with	The software works with Windows.
It is used in...	Commonly found in	This technology is used in hospitals.

SECTION 3: TYPES OF FUEL 🔋 Physical Fuel

English	Definition	Example	Your language
sleep	rest that gives your body energy	"I need eight hours of sleep to function well."	
food	what you eat for energy	"Athletes need healthy food."	
water	the liquid your body needs to survive	"Your body depends on water."	
exercise	physical activity that keeps your body healthy	"Exercise gives me energy."	
electricity	the power that runs machines and devices	"Computers run on electricity."	
coffee	a hot drink many people use for energy	"Many office workers run on coffee."	
caffeine	a substance in coffee and energy drinks that keeps you awake	"Caffeine helps people stay awake."	
sugar	a sweet substance that gives quick energy	"Sugar gives a short energy boost."	
petrol	the fuel used in most cars	"Most cars run on petrol."	
gas	fuel used for heating and transport	"Some cars run on gas."	

🧠 Mental Fuel

English	Definition	Example	Your language
knowledge	information and understanding you have	"Knowledge helps people make good decisions."	
curiosity	the wish to learn new things	"Scientists are driven by curiosity."	
learning	the process of gaining new knowledge	"Students need learning opportunities."	
technology	tools and machines that make work easier	"Many businesses depend on technology."	
creativity	the ability to come up with new ideas	"Designers are powered by creativity."	

❤️ Emotional Fuel

English	Definition	Example	Your language
passion	very strong enthusiasm for something	"Musicians are driven by passion."	
love	deep care and affection for someone	"Parents are motivated by love."	
family	the people closely related to you	"Family gives many people purpose."	
friendship	the support and bond between friends	"Friendship helps people through difficult times."	
success	reaching a goal you wanted	"Some people are motivated by success."	

🏆 Achievement Fuel

English	Definition	Example	Your language
money	what you earn for working	"Many people work for money."	
promotion	moving to a higher position at work	"Employees often aim for promotion."	
recognition	praise you get for good work	"Recognition motivates many workers."	
winning	being the best in a competition	"Athletes love winning."	
innovation	creating new solutions or ideas	"Entrepreneurs are driven by innovation."	

SECTION 4: GAP-FILL ACTIVITYWord Bank

sleep • petrol • coffee • curiosity • family • innovation • discipline • money • electricity • creativity • deadlines • purpose • water • helping others • knowledge

Text

1. A car runs on _____.
2. A smartphone is powered by _____.
3. An athlete depends on _____.
4. A student is often driven by _____.
5. Many workers need _____ to start the day.
6. Good health requires _____.
7. Scientists are often motivated by _____.
8. Entrepreneurs are driven by _____.
9. Artists depend on _____.
10. Parents are motivated by _____.
11. Nurses are often inspired by _____.
12. Success frequently requires _____.
13. Many people work hard for _____.
14. Volunteers are often guided by _____.
15. Productivity sometimes depends on _____.

Answer Key

1. petrol
2. electricity
3. discipline
4. knowledge
5. coffee
6. water
7. curiosity
8. innovation
9. creativity
10. family
11. helping others
12. sleep
13. money
14. purpose
15. deadlines

SECTION 5: SENTENCE EXPANSIONInstructions

Expand each sentence by adding:

- One reason
  - One example
  - One additional detail

Starter Sentences

1. The company is driven by innovation.
2. A teacher needs patience.
3. Success depends on hard work.
4. My phone runs on electricity.
5. An athlete requires discipline.
6. A scientist is motivated by curiosity.
7. A student depends on knowledge.
8. A doctor is driven by helping others.
9. A business needs customers.
10. A parent is motivated by family.

Model Answer

The company is driven by innovation because it wants to stay competitive. For example, Apple regularly develops new products. This helps the company attract customers and grow.

SECTION 6: ROLE-PLAY PREPARATION

Every person has different fuel.

Prepare a 1–1.5 minute speech.

Include:

- Who you are
  - What your fuel is
  - Why it motivates you
  - What happens without it
  - Why your fuel is better than other fuels

Try to use:

- runs on
  - driven by
  - depends on
  - requires
  - needs

SECTION 7: PERSONA CARDSMotivation Profiles

#	Profession	Fuel (Motivator)	Arguments	Weakness
1	Manager	Money	Creates opportunities; Rewards effort; Provides security	Doesn't guarantee happiness
2	Manager	Promotion	Career growth; Recognition; New challenges	Can create stress
3	Teacher	Student Success	Positive impact; Meaningful work; Long-term results	Progress can be slow
4	Artist	Creativity	Self-expression; New ideas; Personal satisfaction	Income may be unstable
5	Doctor	Helping Others	Saves lives; Meaningful career; Community impact	Emotional pressure
6	Student	Knowledge	Personal growth; Better decisions; Future opportunities	Results take time

#	Profession	Fuel (Motivator)	Arguments	Weakness
7	Entrepreneur	Innovation	Solves problems; Creates value; Improves society	High risk
8	Nurse	Patient Care	Helps people recover; Builds trust; Improves lives	Exhausting work
9	Scientist	Discovery	Expands knowledge; Solves mysteries; Advances society	Frequent failure
10	Athlete	Winning	Clear goals; Strong motivation; Achievement	Fear of losing
11	Writer	Storytelling	Shares ideas; Inspires people; Preserves experiences	Creative blocks
12	Engineer	Problem Solving	Practical impact; Innovation; Efficiency	Complex challenges
13	Parent	Family	Love; Responsibility; Future generations	Constant worry
14	Chef	Excellence	Creativity; Customer satisfaction; Professional pride	Long hours; Competitive industry
15	Lawyer	Justice	Protects rights; Fairness; Social impact	Stressful cases
16	Photographer	Capturing Moments	Preserves memories; Creativity; Storytelling	—
17	Salesperson	Targets	Measurable success; Bonuses; Achievement	Pressure
18	Coach	Team Success	Leadership; Shared achievement; Development	Depends on others
19	Designer	Aesthetics	Beauty; Creativity; User experience	Subjective opinions
20	Freelancer	Independence	Freedom; Flexibility; Control	Income uncertainty

SECTION 8: MINI DEBATEUseful Language

- **I believe...**
  - **In my opinion...**
  - **I agree because...**
  - **I disagree because...**
  - **On the other hand...**
  - **That's a good point, but...**
  - **From my perspective...**

Debate Questions

1. Is money the strongest fuel?
2. Can passion be more powerful than talent?
3. Is fear a good motivator?
4. Do successful people need competition?
5. Is helping others better than earning money?
6. Can creativity change the world?
7. Is purpose more important than happiness?
8. Should people follow passion or security?
9. Can pressure improve performance?
10. What fuel creates the most successful people?

SECTION 9: PERSONAL REFLECTION

Complete the sentences:

- My fuel is _____ because _____.
  - Without _____ I would struggle to _____.
  - The thing that motivates me most is _____.
  - In the future I want to be driven by _____.

Pair Discussion

1. Has your fuel changed over time?
2. What fuel did you have as a child?
3. What fuel do successful people need?
4. Can people have more than one fuel?
5. Which fuel is most important in your life?

If this worked in your class

I'm Ondra, an English teacher in the Czech Republic. I teach about thirty classes a week, nearly all adults, and I write these lessons for my own lessons first — then tidy them up so other teachers can use them.

There are twenty more like this one: grammar worksheets, speaking activities, business English, current-events lessons and no-prep games, A1 to C1. Every one has a teacher's guide and an answer key.

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